Activity 6: Standards-Based EPA Audit at Helix Assembly

Objective: Conduct a risk-based audit using observation, measurement, interview and records, then issue graded findings and corrective-action requests.

Scenario

Helix Assembly claims alignment to ANSI/ESD S20.20 and IEC 61340-5-1. A new customer requests evidence that controls are implemented, verified and improved—not merely purchased.

Roles

- lead auditor
- ESD programme coordinator
- customer observer

Detailed procedure

1. Confirm audit scope, criteria, process boundaries, product sensitivity and previous findings.
2. Build a sampling plan across shifts, workstations, products and recent changes.
3. Review the ESD control programme, roles, qualification evidence and compliance-verification plan.
4. Observe EPA entry, grounding, handling, packaging and response to simulated alarms.
5. Interview an operator, technician and manager using role-specific competence questions.
6. Review current measurement, calibration, maintenance, training and change-control records.
7. Trace one ESDS lot from receipt through assembly, test, storage and dispatch.
8. Triangulate each potential finding with at least two evidence types where practical.
9. Grade findings by exposure and system impact; define immediate containment where required.
10. Write each finding with requirement/criterion, objective evidence, gap and risk.
11. Agree owners and target dates without allowing the auditee to close findings during the meeting.
12. Define follow-up evidence and effectiveness checks, then issue the audit report.

Questions

- What evidence shows a control is sustained rather than merely installed?
- Why must the exact controlled standard govern numerical limits?
- What makes a finding actionable?

Evidence to submit

- Audit plan
- Completed checklist
- Evidence register
- Graded findings and follow-up plan

Acceptance criteria

- [ ] Sampling is risk-based
- [ ] Findings cite objective evidence
- [ ] Critical exposure triggers containment
- [ ] Follow-up tests effectiveness, not only completion

Debrief

Explain which evidence changed your first assumption, which control is most reliable, and what follow-up measurement is needed.